Alessandro Vozza

Cloud Platform Architect | Kubernetes, OpenShift & Azure | AI-Native Infrastructure

LinkedIn: /in/alessandrovozza | GitHub: @ams0 | Amsterdam, Netherlands

Summary

Platform architect with 20+ years designing and operating Kubernetes, OpenShift, and Azure infrastructure for regulated enterprises — from OpenStack/OpenShift private clouds at Red Hat, through AKS and landing-zone architecture at Microsoft, to a production multi-cluster Kubernetes estate I run today on bare metal. Golden Kubestronaut and CNCF Ambassador. In parallel, I've spent the last two years building and operating production agentic AI systems, so I bring current, hands-on engineering depth alongside the org-level fluency to work directly with CTOs and platform leadership. I design for production, not for the slide — and I still run the clusters myself.

Core Technical Expertise

Kubernetes & Platform Engineering

Kubernetes (Golden Kubestronaut), RKE2, Talos Linux, Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), OpenShift Container Platform, Azure Red Hat OpenShift (ARO), Kubernetes operators & CRDs, multi-cluster GitOps (ArgoCD), Gateway API, Istio / Gloo Mesh service mesh, Backstage IDP

Azure Architecture

Azure landing zones, Azure Kubernetes Service, Azure Container Apps, Azure AI Foundry, Azure Local (Azure Stack HCI), Azure Arc, Azure DevOps, Terraform / Bicep, zero-trust & DevSecOps architecture

Infrastructure & Virtualization

OpenStack, Proxmox VE, Ceph distributed storage, on-prem/hybrid cloud design, GPU infrastructure & capacity planning

AI / ML

Anthropic Claude APIs, OpenAI, Azure AI Foundry, agentic workflow design, LLM orchestration, MLFlow, Kubeflow

Observability & Security

Datadog, Prometheus, Grafana, DevSecOps, zero-trust network policy

Languages (Programming)

Python, Bash, Go (working knowledge), YAML

Experience

Microsoft — Sr. Solution Engineer, Cloud + AI

2025–present | Amsterdam

- Own and win complex technical evaluations for **Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS)**, **Azure Container Apps**, and **Azure AI Foundry** across enterprise and public-sector accounts, translating platform capability into customer trust and adoption.
- Architect production-grade, regulated workloads on AKS and Container Apps; advise CTOs and platform teams on **GPU infrastructure**, **agentic AI**, and compliance frameworks (DORA, EU AI Act).
- Advise on **Azure Red Hat OpenShift (ARO)** and OpenShift-on-Azure patterns for customers standardising on a portable, Kubernetes-native control plane across hybrid estates.
- Bridge cloud-native infrastructure and the Microsoft 365 / Copilot ecosystem — speaking at ESPC26 on where platform engineering and productivity AI intersect.

Independent Consultant Architect — Lovelace Engineering B.V.

2018–present | Amsterdam

- **Energy (oil & gas) client:** Defined Azure landing-zone and AKS platform architecture for a global infrastructure migration — network segmentation, identity, and policy-as-code guardrails for multi-region workloads.
- **FSI (banking) client:** Designed a secure, regulator-ready cloud-native platform on AKS, using **Istio** for mTLS-by-default, GitOps delivery, and zero-trust network policy aligned to financial-services compliance expectations.
- **FSI (insurance) client:** Led GitOps adoption (**ArgoCD**) across a multi-cluster Kubernetes estate, moving delivery teams to self-service, auditable deployments.
- **Enterprise client:** Cloud-native platform advisory, applying the same workflow- and decision-rights redesign used across the other engagements.
- Recurring pattern across engagements: Kubernetes architecture choices — mesh or no mesh, multi-cluster vs. multi-tenant, managed vs. self-hosted — are organisational decisions as much as technical ones.

Kubespaces.io — Founder & CEO

2024–present | Amsterdam

- Designed and built a **Kubernetes namespaces-as-a-service** product: ephemeral, self-service namespace provisioning with quota, network policy, and RBAC guardrails by default.
- Owned the control-plane design powering on-demand environment lifecycle (create, suspend, destroy) for developer self-service at scale.
- Took the architecture and product story to investors and presented internationally at cloud-native conferences.

Solo.io — Senior Platform Advocate

2022–2024 | Remote / Amsterdam

- Led GTM and technical evangelism for **Istio**-based service mesh (**Gloo Mesh**) and **Gloo Gateway** (Envoy-based API gateway) across enterprise accounts.
- Ran hands-on workshops and produced technical content on multi-cluster service mesh, **Gateway API**, and zero-trust network architecture for global audiences.
- Translated Kubernetes networking and distributed-systems concepts for C-suite and engineering audiences alike, driving product adoption through community and education.

Microsoft — Principal Software Engineer, Cloud Solution Architect

November 2016–December 2022 | Amsterdam

- Delivered **AKS** readiness, deployment, and DevOps engagements for enterprise customers — covering cluster architecture, CI/CD, security baselines, and production operations.
- Designed and delivered **OpenShift-on-Azure** architecture and workshops for enterprise customers, bridging Red Hat's container platform with Azure infrastructure.
- Architected secure landing zones and AKS platforms for financial-services and public-sector accounts, focused on network isolation, identity, and policy-as-code.
- Authored Kubernetes troubleshooting, auditing, and security best-practice guidance, shared internally and externally via KubeCon talks.

Freelance Cloud Native Architect

2014–2016 | Amsterdam

- Independent consulting on on-prem **OpenStack**, **Ceph**, and **OpenShift** deployments for European enterprise customers, ahead of the broad enterprise shift to public cloud.
- Designed and operated private cloud platforms — compute, network, and Ceph block/object storage — as the foundation for early OpenShift Container Platform rollouts.

Red Hat — Principal Architect, OpenStack & OpenShift

2012–2014 | Amsterdam

- Designed and led **OpenStack** and **OpenShift** deployments for enterprise customers across EMEA, defining compute, network, and Ceph/Swift storage architecture.
- Built early cloud-native transformation playbooks — container platform patterns, multi-tenancy, private-cloud operations — before “digital transformation” was the term of art.

Linux Foundation — Certified Instructor

2018–present

- Delivered Kubernetes and cloud-native training internationally, covering **CKA**, **CKAD**, and **CKS** curricula.
- Trained hundreds of engineers across skill levels; developed and adapted curriculum for diverse technical audiences.

Selected Technical Projects

Production Multi-Cluster Kubernetes Infrastructure

2025–present

- Run an **11-node Proxmox cluster** co-located at a commercial datacenter (NorthC, Amsterdam) with **Ceph** distributed storage backing **RKE2** and **Talos Linux** Kubernetes distributions.
- Resolved etcd snapshot restoration on Talos, Ceph health incidents, and CSI/storage issues in a live environment.
- Benchmarked LLM inference endpoints and planned GPU capacity for a 64×B300 cluster supporting a commercial AI inference service.

Hybrid Identity for Azure Local

2026

- Stood up Active Directory Domain Services on Windows Server 2022 as the identity backend for an **Azure Local (Azure Stack HCI)** deployment — DNS, NTP, and AD configuration on Proxmox-virtualised infrastructure, mirroring production hybrid-cloud identity architecture.

Agentic AI Automation Platform

2024–present

- Built a production multi-agent system on Anthropic’s Claude API, deployed via **Azure Container Apps** with a LiteLLM proxy, integrated across Discord, Slack, Telegram, and WhatsApp.
- Agents own end-to-end workflows — calendar management, communications triage, research, code generation — with no human in the loop for routine work.

Internal Developer Platform for 15 Engineering Teams

2023–2024

- Designed and shipped a **Backstage**-based IDP with GitHub Actions, standardising delivery workflows across 15 teams; reduced onboarding time by 60% and gave leadership real-time visibility into deployment frequency.

Multicluster Progressive Delivery

2023

- Architected a zero-downtime deployment pipeline using **ArgoCD**, **Gateway API**, and **Istio** across multiple Kubernetes clusters — 100% uptime during deployments with full rollback capability.

Certifications

- **Golden Kubestronaut** (Linux Foundation) — the full Kubernetes/CNCF certification stack: CKA, CKAD, CKS, and the complete CNCF associate suite.

- Azure Solution Architect Expert (Microsoft)
- Azure DevOps Engineer Expert (Microsoft)
- Azure Security Engineer (Microsoft)
- Google Professional Cloud Architect
- AWS Cloud Practitioner
- GitHub Copilot Certified
- Microsoft Certified Trainer
- Green Software Foundation Champion

Community & Speaking

- **CNCF Ambassador**
- Co-organiser, Cloud Native Community Days Amsterdam (organising since 2019)
- Organiser, Cloud Native Rejekts EU 2026 (Amsterdam)
- Conference speaker: KubeCon + CloudNativeCon and regional cloud-native meetups

Education

Ph.D. Chemistry — University of Amsterdam, 2004–2008

Languages

- **Italian** — Native
- **English** — Fluent (professional)
- **Dutch** — Professional working proficiency
- **Modern Greek** — Learning